

tively inexpensive, especially with the proliferation of multi-megapixel digital cameras that can be directly transferred into your graphics software with little or no loss of color information. If you are keen on artwork, and you find that you aren't up to speed in that area, you could try roping in a friend who knows graphics design, or visit one of the graphics design schools in your area. Senior-year students should be more than willing to provide you with eye-catching designs at a fraction of the cost of professional design shops. You can also scour the Internet for royalty-free artwork designs.

When working with images, make sure you're using a minimum resolution of 300 dpi. Higher than that is always better! Colour information and details tend to get lost below 300 dpi, making your printout look shabby. Similarly, the choice of text and font styles should also be given careful consideration. Remember that your cover art is a combination of the graphics image as well as the superimposed text. While the text should be legible and easy on the human eye, it should not crowd out the rest of the artwork, unless you have a very strong reason for that stylistic choice.

Choosing a font style is no easy task. You cannot just slap on any old font. If you are clueless about what fonts to use, a good idea maybe to check out other CDs in your genre and look at the kind of fonts and artwork those artists are using. It might give you an idea of what works and what will not. Some cover art has an instant direct appeal. Others just slip past you without catching your eye. When using dark colors or a background filled with images it might be difficult for the text to stand out on its own. In that case, it would be good idea to use a solid color box and embed the text inside that to make it stand out and not get lost in the background.

14.2.2. The software

You will need graphic design and desktop publishing software to design your artwork. For best results, you may need to use a combination of graphics and image editing software before getting